

Black Templars — Templar Bastion Runbook

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Mindset

Play it as a patient CONTROL grinder, not a race. The plan: hold objectives with durable Battleline bricks, auspex-scan whatever's in front of you so the whole army re-rolls into it, and stack the debuffs (pin the melee threats off you, suppress the shooters) while the Interception-Strike RepExes and the crit-5 Sword Brethren delete the priority piece. Three disciplines: (1) DON'T over-extend the bricks — you win by holding and out-lasting, so make the enemy come to you and grind them under -1-to-wound (Angels Defiant) + the +1 T/AP relic; (2) SPEND the debuff strats on the thing that decides the turn (pin the charge that would break a brick, suppress the alpha); (3) use the EC + Combi-Lieutenant as scalpels — assassinate a key character, limpet a key objective. Accept the two bad matchups (fast kiting gun lists, true hordes) and grind everyone else.

Weighted ~51%. The Bastion Task Force is a durable hold-and-debuff army: it grinds Take-and-Hold

matchups on quality + the auspex-scan control toolkit; the horde remains the hardest game.

Tapestry quick-reference

Rule	What it does
Templar Vows — ACCEPT ANY CHALLENGE (the army rule; NOT Oath)	BT don't get Oath of Moment; they pick ONE Templar Vow army-wide. Default = Accept Any Challenge: each melee attack where the attacker's S <= the target's T gets +1 to Wound. It helps you wound UP into tough things (vehicles/monsters/elites) — exactly where the melee bricks need help. Switch to Uphold the Honour (INFANTRY sticky objectives) only vs a majority-T3 army (where S>T means Accept does nothing).
Interlocking Tactics (detachment rule) + AUSPEX	BATTLELINE units can Advance/Fall Back and still shoot + declare a charge (+ do Actions). And whenever a Battleline unit attacks, pick one enemy unit it hit -> it's AUSPEX SCANNED; every model in your army re-rolls Hit rolls of 1 vs a scanned target. That's your army-wide accuracy engine (this list's substitute for Oath) + the mobility that lets the bricks reposition.
Interception Strike — the RELIABLE guns (Repulsor Executioner)	BT datasheet rule: each RepEx re-rolls ALL Hit rolls when it targets a unit within 12" of a friendly Astartes unit — in a brick army that's basically always on. So both Heavy Laser Destroyers (S16 AP-4 D6+4) + gatlings + multi-meltas fire re-rolling every turn: dependable ranged AT + anti-infantry with NO delivery risk. This is why the list is consistent.
The Sword Brethren HAMMER (crit-5 Lethal, made Battleline)	Marshal (INSPIRATIONAL EXEMPLAR: unmodified Hit 5+ = Critical Hit) + Sword Brethren power weapons [LETHAL HITS] (crit -> auto-wound) + Castellan (VEHEMENT AGGRESSION re-roll) + Accept vow (+1 wound up) + 2 thunder hammers (S8 Dev). Hero of the Chapter makes it BATTLELINE, so LIGHT OF VENGEANCE (1CP) can bolt [SUSTAINED HITS 1] on top -> more crit-5s -> more

auto-wounds. It cracks vehicles/monsters IN MELEE (Questoris/Dominus have no melee invuln). NOTE: no Slayers +2S here — that's Marshal's Household, a different detachment.

Grimaldus — the relic anvil (no unit FNP) Litanyes of the Devout: the led unit re-rolls ALL melee Hits. Temple Relics (each Command phase, needs the Cenobytes): default WATER FROM THE STOUP = +1 AP for the unit's melee (power fists AP-2->AP-3, chainswords AP-1->AP-2); alts COLUMN = +1 Toughness (defensive pivot), BANNER = +1 Advance & Charge. FNP 5+ is Grimaldus + Cenobytes ONLY — the brick's durability is bodies + the relic + Angels Defiant, not FNP.

The debuff / control toolkit (Bastion stratagems) Layer onto the auspex scan: GUIDED DISRUPTION (pin: -2" Move, -2 Charge), SHOCK BOMBARDMENT (suppress: -1 to Hit), CODEX DISCIPLINE (re-roll Hits, +Wound-1s vs scanned), LIGHT OF VENGEANCE (Lethal or Sustained vs scanned), ANGELS DEFIANT (a Battleline unit gets -1 to Wound vs attacks where S>T -> the key defensive tech), HERESY UNDONE (a non-Battleline unit advance+charge). ~1 strat/turn (CP-limited); pick the priority.

The Emperor's Champion — the scalpel Black Sword S8 AP-3 (AP-4 with Blades of Valour) D3 A6 [ANTI-CHARACTER 5+, PRECISION]. He alone picks out and kills an attached enemy Character in melee (Sigismund's Heir re-rolls a charge to reach a Character within 12"). Save him for the enemy's key buff-character.

The Combi-Lieutenant — the objective limpet LONE OPERATIVE (can't be shot >12") + FNP 5+ + Priority Objective (army re-rolls Wound-1s vs enemies near his nominated objective) + Evade and Survive (a REACTIVE Normal move in the enemy's turn when a unit ends a move within 9"). Nearly impossible to shift; anchors a corner and buffs the army's wounding there.

What this list genuinely can't do (1) CATCH a fast/kiting gun army — everything is M6 foot bricks (advance-and-charge helps, but a Drukhar or a shooting-Knight list out-manoevres and shoots it off); (2) out-BODY a true horde (Orks) on primary. It's durable and reliable, so it has few bad matchups — but it wins the LONG game, not the tempo game.

Per-matchup battle plans (10 archetypes)

Emperor's Children — 70% (Favourable) · you play **Immovable Object vs their **Purge the Foe (they play Unstoppable Force)****

Deciding factor: You out-durable and out-grind the paper swarm: the +1 T/-1-to-wound bricks eat the Infractor/Daemonette melee, Interception guns delete a Defiler/turn (their only real anti-armour), and the crit-5 Sword Brethren + Accept vow crush the elites. Their AP-1/-2 volume is the wrong shape for your armour.

Plan:

- Interception RepExes delete a Defiler each turn; pin/suppress the Infractors off your line.
- Let the chaff break on the Grimaldus anvil (re-roll hits + relic + Angels Defiant); Sword Brethren counter-punch.
- EC Precision-kills a Lord Exultant/buff-char; hold primary and grind — they can't out-durable or out-score you.

Watch: Fulgrim (Fights First) can trade into a brick before it swings — pin him (-2 charge) or bait him onto the anvil first.

Orks — 33% (Unfavourable) · you play **Battlefield Dominance vs their Take and Hold (they play Battlefield Dominance)**

Deciding factor: The one thing that beats a durable brick army: raw BODIES. ~100 Boyz out-score your holders on primary, and the flood blankets objectives your M6 bricks can't all cover. Your gatlings + Sword Brethren mow Boyz in bulk, but you can't clear 100 or out-body the tide.

Plan:

- Gatlings (A12 Dev, Interception re-rolls) + Sword Brethren + anvil mow Boyz; suppress the klaw-nob brick that cracks your armour.
- Hold 2-3 objectives hard (relic +1T anvil), concede the middle; the Combi-Lieutenant limpets a corner.
- Interception guns delete the Kill Rig/Stompa; race secondaries — you won't win the primary body-count.

Watch: Getting out-actioned and out-bodied. Honest ~22% — minimise the margin, don't chase kills.

Adeptus Mechanicus — 45% (Coin-flip) · you play **Inescapable Dominion vs their Priority Assets (they play Secure Asset)**

Deciding factor: Their D6-damage anti-tank OVER-kills your bodies (waste) and Angels Defiant blunts the rest, while your Interception guns + Sword Brethren delete a Kataphron brick/turn and you out-body their low-model gunline. Advance-and-charge (Interlocking Tactics) closes the distance and their line folds in melee.

Plan:

- Interception RepExes delete a Kataphron brick each turn; suppress/pin the shooters (-1 hit, -2 move).
- Advance the Battleline bricks into the gunline (few melee bodies); Sword Brethren + power-fist Crusaders carve it.
- Out-score — hold with bodies once their shooting is tar-pitted in melee.

Watch: Culexus/Callidus sniping your buff characters (Marshal/Grimaldus) — screen them with the bricks.

T'au Empire — 63% (Favourable) · you play **Immovable Object vs their Purge the Foe (they play Unstoppable Force)**

Deciding factor: This is where Bastion shines vs a melee list: you SURVIVE the alpha (2+ saves + Angels Defiant -1 to wound vs their high-S rail/fusion) AND you shoot BACK reliably (Interception RepExes, no delivery to strand). Suppress the suits, out-body, and grind — T'au fold in melee if you reach, and your guns punish them if they don't.

Plan:

- Weather the alpha behind durability; do NOT waste CP on nothing (their AP-4/-5 ignores armour anyway — lean on Angels Defiant + bodies).
- Interception guns delete a Riptide/Crisis brick each turn; SUPPRESS the markerlight Pathfinders + the alpha (-1 to hit).
- Advance the bricks; Sword Brethren crush anything that lingers; hold primary with bodies they can't shift fast enough.

Watch: Rail/fusion Devastating Wounds spike through saves; spread bricks to limit mortal spillover. A real coin-flip — practise it.

Necrons — 50% (Coin-flip) · you play **Battlefield Dominance vs their Take and Hold (they play Battlefield Dominance)**

Deciding factor: C'tan durability (4+/-1Dmg/reanim) blunts your removal and they out-grind on reanimating bodies; you can't table 3 shards. Your edge: reliable guns + the crit-5 Sword Brethren (Accept vow +1 wound) chip a C'tan, and you out-durable the rest. A grind you steal on objectives.

Plan:

- Focus ONE C'tan with guns + the Sword Brethren brick (spread chip just reanimates); EC snipes a Technomancer.
- Hold with the relic anvil + bodies; suppress the gauss to cut their return fire.
- Win on sticky primary + secondaries, not on the body-count.

Watch: Reanimation refunding your chip, and their forced-battle-shock C'tan strat (test at -1 + mortals) hitting a key holder — focus-remove whole units.

Adeptus Custodes — 49% (Coin-flip) · you play **Battlefield Dominance vs their Take and Hold (they play Battlefield Dominance)**

Deciding factor: Elite mirror you edge on VOLUME + reliability: you have far more bodies, the Interception guns + crit-5 Sword Brethren delete a Caladius/Custodian brick, and the EC's PRECISION Black Sword duels their characters where their own attached chars can't cleanly answer. Angels Defiant + the anvil out-last their few models.

Plan:

- Guns + Sword Brethren delete a Custodian brick/turn; PIN the Wardens/Blade Champion off your line.
- EMPEROR'S CHAMPION vs their character (Precision + Anti-Character) = a real melee assassination.
- Out-body + hold; they have ~40 models, you have more + the auspex debuffs.

Watch: Their melee out-damages a single brick head-on; gang two units + pin before you commit.

Blood Angels — 51% (Coin-flip) · you play **Battlefield Dominance vs their Take and Hold (they play Battlefield Dominance)**

Deciding factor: A glass melee alpha into a durable hold-and-punish army is a good matchup for you: you RECEIVE the charge behind 2+/Angels Defiant + Grimaldus re-roll-hits, overwatch thins the drop, and you counter-punch with a fresh Sword Brethren brick + the EC. They fold once the alpha is spent; you don't.

Plan:

- Screen so DC/Sang Guard land 9"+ out; gatling + Assault Intercessor overwatch thins them; SUPPRESS the alpha.
- Weather the charge on the anvil (Angels Defiant -1 wound); counter-charge the spent unit with the Sword Brethren + EC on their Priest/Lemartes.
- Out-grind and out-score — you're the durable one here.

Watch: Getting a key brick charged before it can Angels-Defiant; hold the strat for the swing charge.

Dark Angels — 37% (Unfavourable) · you play **Inescapable Dominion vs their Priority Assets (they play Secure Asset)**

Deciding factor: Terminator mirror decided on primary: your Interception HLDs + the crit-5 Sword Brethren (Lethal auto-wounds SKIP the to-wound roll, grinding the 4+/-1Dmg mace brick better than normal attacks) chew

the Deathwing, and you out-body + out-shoot. Both slow -> board position + the sticky anvil decide it.

Plan:

- Guns + Sword Brethren focus the Deathwing brick (Lethal-on-5 volume beats the 4++); the Lion is a Monster -> shoot him.
- PIN/suppress the mace brick to slow its advance; hold objectives + grind.
- Race primary; your body-count + reliable guns edge the mirror.

Watch: Feeding a single brick piecemeal into the mace; commit with support + pin first.

Drukhari — 52% (Coin-flip) · you play **Purge and Secure** vs their **Reconnaissance (they play Reconnaissance Sweep)**

Deciding factor: Speed is your kryptonite: they out-manoeuvre M6, kite the bricks, dark-lance the RepExes, and flip objectives late. Your armour + Angels Defiant tank the splinter fine and your guns shoot their paper down when they're near your line — but you CAN'T catch them, and a durable slow army loses the tempo game to pure speed.

Plan:

- Hold a tight castle + the Combi-Lieutenant limpet; make them commit into your bubble (their paper folds if it does).
- Interception guns one-shot Ravagers/Venoms to cut mobility + the lance threat; PIN what you can.
- Zone with screens + the jump squads so they can't backfield-raid; grind the secondaries you can hold.

Watch: Out-actioned and out-scored by raw speed while the bricks chase air. ~34% — a real underdog game.

Astra Militarum — 43% (Lean unfavourable) · you play **Inescapable Dominion** vs their **Priority Assets (they play Secure Asset)**

Deciding factor: Their tanks are Interception-Strike food (2 Heavy Laser Destroyers re-rolling hits + multi-meltas delete a Russ/superheavy a turn) and their D6-damage guns over-kill your bodies (waste). You out-body the low-model tank line, advance-and-charge into the infantry, and hold.

Plan:

- Interception RepExes + Sword Brethren delete a Russ/Shadowsword each turn; suppress the artillery.
- Advance the bricks; power-fist Crusaders + Sword Brethren carve the Guard infantry.
- Out-body and out-score once the shooting is tar-pitted in melee.

Watch: Artillery + Leontus orders chipping the bricks early; screen them to the first melee. Slight favour if you weather T1-2.

The list

Unit	×	Role / wargear	Pts
Emperor's Champion + Blades of Valour	1	WARLORD. Leads the 10 Assault Intercessors. Black Sword S8 AP-3->AP-4 D3 A6 [ANTI-CHARACTER 5+, PRECISION] -> character-assassin. Blades of Valour = +1 AP melee for his Battleline unit (chainswords AP-1->AP-2).	105
Assault Intercessor Squad	10	Bodyguard (Battleline). AP-2 chainswords (Blades of Valour), auspex-scan generator, advance-and-charge (Interlocking Tactics). Mobile scanning melee	150

brick + the EC.

Chaplain Grimaldus (+3 Cenobyte)	1	Leads the 20-Crusader anvil. Litanies = re-roll ALL melee Hits (unit); Temple Relics (Command phase, default +1 AP / alt +1 T / +1 Adv&Charge). FNP 5+ on HIM + Cenobytes only.	100
Lieutenant (Support)	1	Stacks into the Crusader anvil — a support wound-buff character.	45
Crusader Squad	20	Bodyguard (Battleline). THE ANVIL: 20 bodies, 4 power fists (S8 AP-2->AP-3 w/ relic) + master-crafted power weapon. Re-roll all melee Hits (Grimaldus), +1 AP relic, Angels Defiant (-1 to wound). Sticky, hard to shift.	290
Marshal + Hero of the Chapter	1	Leads the Sword Brethren. INSPIRATIONAL EXEMPLAR: unmodified Hit of 5+ = Critical Hit. HERO OF THE CHAPTER: the Marshal gains BATTLELINE -> the whole Sword Brethren brick counts as Battleline (unlocks Interlocking Tactics + Bastion strats for it).	100
Castellan (Support)	1	Stacks into the Sword Brethren. VEHEMENT AGGRESSION: re-roll Hits -> more 5+ crits to convert via Lethal Hits.	70
Sword Brethren Squad	10	Bodyguard. THE HAMMER: 6 master-crafted power weapons [LETHAL HITS] + 2 thunder hammers (S8 [DEV]) + 2 twin lightning claws. With crit-on-5 + re-rolls + Accept vow (+1 wound up), it deletes vehicles/monsters IN MELEE (no invuln vs Questoris/Dominus). Battleline via Hero of the Chapter -> Light of Vengeance adds Sustained.	260
Lieutenant with Combi-weapon	1	LONE OPERATIVE + FNP 5+. Priority Objective Identified: nominate 1 objective -> the whole army re-rolls Wound-1s vs enemies near it. Evade and Survive: a REACTIVE move (Normal move in the enemy's turn when they end a move within 9"). A near-unkillable objective limpet.	95
Intercessor Squad	5	Battleline objective holder + scanner; advance-and-shoot (Interlocking Tactics).	80
Assault Intercessors w/ Jump Packs	5	Battleline, deep-strike + advance-and-charge -> a mobile scanner / objective-grabber (x2 in the list).	85
Assault Intercessors w/ Jump Packs	5	2nd jump squad — reserve pressure / late-objective flex.	85
Repulsor Executioner	1	The gun: Heavy Laser Destroyer (S16 AP-4 D6+4) AT + Heavy Onslaught Gatling (A12 [Dev]) anti-infantry + multi-melta. INTERCEPTION STRIKE = full Hit re-roll vs anything within 12" of a friendly unit. Reliable removal, every turn.	265
Repulsor Executioner	1	2nd gun platform (2nd Heavy Laser Destroyer + gatling). Two Interception-Strike RepExes = the army's dependable damage.	265